COVER STORY

# SEMAGLUTIDE

# THE WONDER DRUG

**Its promise as a miracle medication for diabetes and obesity is taking the world–and India–by storm, but its indiscriminate use for weight loss could have dire consequences**

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**Nitin Chaddha (name changed), a 44-year-old businessman** in Delhi, gained 23 kilos during the Covid pandemic. It affected not just his marital relationship, but also his self-esteem. "I couldn't bear to look at myself in the mirror, or have my pictures taken," he says. Then, he approached the doctor who had been treating his brother for diabetes. His brother is taking Rybelsus, the oral version of Ozempic, both of which contain a revolutionary ingredient called semaglutide, which while helping regulate sugar, also results in weight loss. "My brother lost seven kilos in a few months," says Chaddha, who is not diabetic but is morbidly obese, with a BMI of 34. "I met his doctor and, under his guidance, used the drug to lose 10 kilos myself." He has been on Rybelsus for four months now.